

direct object

The person or thing affected by the action of the **verb**, e.g. "him" in **We followed him**. see also **indirect object**

direct question

A question without an introductory phrase, e.g. **What time is it?**

direct speech

The words that are actually said to make a statement or question, e.g. **It's raining**.

discourse marker

A word or phrase that is used in conversation to direct the discussion or add comment, e.g. **Well, Right**.

double object verb

A verb that has two objects, e.g. "me" and "the phone" in **Give me the phone**.

dummy subject

The word "it" used without referring to a noun, e.g. **It's five o'clock**.

-ed adjective

An adjective that describes how something is affected, e.g. **bored, excited**. see also **-ing adjective**

ellipsis

When words or phrases are left out of a clause, usually because they don't need to be repeated, e.g. **He got up and [he] had a shower**.

emphasis

When a word is said more loudly because it is more important. see also **stress**

extreme adjective

An adjective that has a stronger meaning than a **gradable adjective** with a similar meaning, e.g. **freezing** is the extreme adjective for **cold**.

first conditional

A sentence with "if" that describes a possible future situation that depends on another situation, e.g. **If it rains, I'll stay here**.

focus

Part of a **sentence** that is moved to the beginning because it is more important.

formal

Formal language is used in situations where you don't know the people very well, or when you want to keep social distance. see also **informal**

future continuous

A **tense** that is formed with **will be** and the **present participle**. It expresses an action that will be in progress at a point in the future.

future perfect

A **tense** that is formed with **will have** and the **past participle**, e.g. **will have done**. It expresses an action that will be complete at a point in the future.

future perfect continuous

A **tense** that is formed with **will have been** and the **present participle**, e.g. **will have been doing**. It expresses an ongoing action that will be complete at a point in the future.

gerund (verbal noun)

The **-ing** form of a **verb**, when it is used as a noun, e.g. **No smoking**.

gradable adjective

An adjective that can be used with **adverbs of degree** (such as **very**) and can be used in the **comparative** form. see also **non-gradable adjective**

grading adverb

An **adverb of degree** that can be used with **gradable adjectives**. see also **non-grading adverb**

hedging

Words or phrases that make a speaker seem less certain or direct, e.g. **apparently, I think**.

imperative

An order to someone, e.g. **Stop!** The imperative is often a **verb** on its own in its **base form**.

indefinite article

The words **a** and **an**, which come before **nouns** when it doesn't matter which noun is being referred to, or if it is being mentioned for the first time, e.g. **Can I borrow a pen?** see also **definite article**

indefinite pronoun

A pronoun that does not refer to a specific person or thing, e.g. **someone, nothing**.

indirect object

The person or thing that is affected by the action of a **transitive verb**, but is not the direct object, e.g. "the dog" in **I gave the ball to the dog**. see also **direct object**

indirect question

A question that begins with a polite phrase, e.g. **Can you tell me what time it is?**

infinitive

The **base form** of a **verb**, often with the infinitive marker "to," e.g. **to go, to run**.

infinitive clause

A clause whose verb is in the **infinitive** form, e.g. **It's important to complete the form in full**.

informal

Informal language is used in situations where you know the people well and feel relaxed. see also **formal**

-ing adjective

An adjective that describes the effect something has, e.g. **boring, exciting**. see also **-ed adjective**

inseparable phrasal verb

A **phrasal verb** that is always used with the **particle**, e.g. **I take after my mother**. see also **separable phrasal verb**

intransitive verb

A verb that does not take a **direct object**. see also **transitive verb**

introductory "it"

"It is" used at the start of a **sentence** to refer to a general idea, e.g. **It is difficult to ski**.

inversion

When positions of two parts of a **clause** swap around, e.g. the **subject** and the **verb** in questions.

irregular

A word that behaves differently from most words like it, e.g. **men** is an irregular **plural noun**. see also **regular**

linking verb

A verb that links two parts of a **clause** (the **subject** and **complement**) rather than describing an action, such as **be, seem, become**, e.g. **She is really angry**.

main clause

A **clause** that could form a complete **sentence** on its own. see also **subordinate clause**

main verb

The verb in a group of verbs that carries the meaning, e.g. "ride" in **I can ride a bike**.

modal verb

A type of **auxiliary verb** that is used with a **main verb** to show ideas like ability and permission.

modifier

A word that adds information to another word, e.g. "really" in **really interesting**.

negative

A **clause** that contains a word like **not** or **never**.